Yuhang *Zhang*

Cover Letter — TexSyn VII Submission, May 2026

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Dear TexSyn VII Recruitment Team,

I am a Ph.D. candidate in chemistry at the University of Houston (expected 2027), working in the May group on **complex molecule synthesis** and **asymmetric catalysis**. I am writing to submit my application to the centralized TexSyn VII recruitment portal, with sincere interest in synthesis and method-development opportunities at **Pfizer, Bristol Myers Squibb, Genentech, and Nurix Therapeutics**. My target roles are in **medicinal chemistry, synthesis chemist / R&D, and process development** at U.S. pharma and biotech organizations. A B.S. in Chemical Engineering (Technion, China campus) gives me a process-and-scale-up lens on synthetic chemistry that complements my graduate training in asymmetric catalysis.

As **lead contributor** on a 2nd-generation chiral bidentate Rh_2(II) biscarboxylate catalyst, I executed the **7-step total synthesis** of the bidentate ligand at hundreds-of-milligrams to gram scale and am currently assembling the metal complex. In **medicinal-chemistry side-projects**, I synthesized warfarin derivatives via R-TN1-organocatalyzed conjugate addition for my Oral Research Proposal and produced a gram-scale flavone scaffold for an arylboronic-acid-driven analog series planned for biological-activity studies. My earlier **polymer chemistry** work synthesized fluorinated poly(arylene piperidinium) hydroxide candidates aimed at anion-exchange-membrane applications, characterized by NMR and MALDI-TOF.

My near-term goal is to complete validation of the dirhodium catalyst and advance it toward enantioselective carbene cascade applications; longer-term, I am motivated to grow into chemical-biology-adjacent areas through industrial collaboration and to contribute to drug discovery and method-development teams where rigorous synthesis, catalyst design, and analytical characterization translate directly into program impact. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my synthetic and analytical skill set could support your teams. Thank you for organizing this recruitment channel and for your consideration of my application.

Sincerely,

Yuhang Zhang